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(HANSARD)

HOUSE OF COMMONS

OFFICIAL REPORT

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LONDON
HIS MAJESTY'S STATIONERY OFFICE
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Mr. Paton: On the question of the driving test, especially in view of the fact that drivers of those countries would perhaps be more experienced in their own countries and in driving on the other side of the road, is the Minister satisfied that they are qualified to drive in this country, and will he take steps to ensure that they are?

ANGLO-YUGOSLAV COMPENSATION AGREEMENT

51. **Mr. William Teeling** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs why the first payment by Yugoslavia to this country, due in September, has not been paid; and what steps are being taken to see that Yugoslavia honours her agreement.

Mr. Mayhew: The first payment by Yugoslavia under the Anglo-Yugoslav Compensation Agreement of 23rd December, 1948, is not due until 23rd December next. The second part of the Question does not, therefore, arise.

Mr. Teeling: When the hon. Gentleman says it is not due until December, does that mean that there has been no change made at all, because at one period it was definitely stated that the first payment would be in September?

Mr. Mayhew: I am not aware of that; I always thought it was 23rd December.

FORMOSA (STATUS)

52. **Mr. Teeling** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs whether he will make a statement on the present position in Formosa; whether we have representatives there and to whom they are accredited; and what is to be the eventual settlement with regard to Formosa.

Mr. Mayhew: His Majesty's Government maintain a consulate in Tamsui which is in charge of a regular member of His Majesty's Foreign Service. He maintains contact with the Chinese Nationalist authorities who are in control of the island. Any change in the legal status of Formosa can only be formally effected in a treaty of peace with Japan. But what the eventual settlement will be is a matter which His Majesty's Government cannot decide alone.

Mr. Teeling: Am I to understand that the consul is working under direct instructions from London or from the ambassador who was formerly working in Nanking?

Mr. Mayhew: He certainly does not get them from the ambassador. Such instructions as he gets, I should have thought, are directly from us.

AUSTRIA (DETAINED BRITISH SOLDIERS)

53. **Lieut.-Colonel Lipton** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs what steps he is taking to secure the release of 23017561 Private B. Tyndall, Northants Regiment, from detention by the Soviet authorities in Austria.

Mr. Mayhew: I am glad to be able to inform my hon. and gallant Friend that Private Tyndall and Private Newsam were released by the Soviet authorities on 12th November, and are now with their regiment in Vienna.

Lieut.-Colonel Lipton: While congratulating my hon. Friend on the successful outcome of these particular negotiations with the Soviet authorities, will he make representations in favour of early compassionate leave for Private Tyndall, whose father is seriously ill in hospital as a result of weeks of anxiety?

Mr. Mayhew: I think that question is now one for my right hon. Friend the Secretary of State for War.

UNITED KINGDOM AND ITALY

54. **Mr. Ivor Thomas** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs whether he will invite the Italian Foreign Minister to London for a discussion of outstanding Anglo-Italian differences.

Mr. Mayhew: My right hon. Friend has had the pleasure of several meetings with the Italian Foreign Minister during their recent visit to Paris. There seems no need to arrange any further special meetings for the time being.

Mr. Ivor Thomas: May I hope that the question of further improving Anglo-Italian relations was considered in those talks?